

A Headless CMS:

Delivering Pure Content in the Age of Mobile-first Internet



A headless CMS (content management system) is a back-end-only version built from the ground up as a content repository that makes content accessible via a RESTful API for display on any device. It is designated 'headless' because it does not have a front-end. A headless CMS is focused on storing and delivering structured content.

What started on October 29, 1969, with ARPANET (under the US Department of Defence) delivering a message from one computer to another, became the Internet as we know it today. It is the hub of information that's available and accessible around the globe to everyone. About 60 per cent of the world's population has access to the Internet and there are innumerable apps, software, distributed systems and smart devices that use it — enabling what was once in the realm of sci-fi movies and stories. The Internet today is one of the most profitable mediums to make money. From small time creators to large Internet companies, everyone depends on the content to generate revenue. This is coupled with analytics to understand what people like,

individually and as part of communities, so that the content can be created to suit their tastes and mood.

The need for CMSs

Much of what you experience as the Internet is powered by the information that is stored in back-end systems of the apps that you use today. Internet companies, schools, universities and even governments store information about you to understand your behaviour, share content with you and to function in meaningful ways.

When the World Wide Web became a phenomenon, it allowed people to share information without boundaries. Anyone with a basic understanding of HTML could create Web pages and host them on a website. It was just Web pages initially and when things caught on, we needed something better to create, store and present the content.

This gave birth to content management systems (CMSs), which revolutionised the way we create information, store it and present it to users. The CMSs enabled people to collaborate to create content and share it with others, in an instant. Soon, people didn't need to understand HTML in order to create and share content, as the CMS evolved to accommodate complex content creation requirements and provided the building blocks to enable collaboration, document management and storage.

As content became king and with more users and complex content, there was the need to ensure that users could access the content whenever they wanted and from wherever they were. The content delivery networks (CDN) evolved to meet this need. The CDNs

